This Chinese approach through the Russians was a clever tactic. However, in the decade since 2009, the Indian side had seen through the various Chinese moves. It became apparent that a Chinese veto in the Security Council would have been disadvantageous for China since all resolutions on terrorism up to that time had been passed by consensus. China would not want to be publicly singled out as a lone holdout, viewed by the international community as exercising privilege in the Security Council on an issue such as terrorism. Therefore, India's counter-response was that this matter was not procedural but entirely political, not multilateral but bilateral, and that any further delay by the Chinese in blocking the listing of Masood Azhar might have an adverse impact on India–China relations. The Russians presumably conveyed this to the Chinese.

One of the hallmarks of Chinese negotiating tactics is to repeatedly press the same point, and in different ways. While this is irritating and even offending for the opposite number, it is really intended to allow the Chinese to make a determination of their opponent's bottom line. The objective is to wear down the opposition to get them to reveal whether their position on any matter is merely tactical (in which case there is scope for further negotiation) or the final position. In the present case, all of China's tactics—the use of committee procedures, the efforts to get India and Pakistan to bilaterally resolve the matter, the claim that this was not an India–China problem, the Russian gambit—had failed to kick the can down the road beyond 23 May 2019, as they had hoped.

Now, China presumably weighed the consequences of vetoing the US resolution in the Security Council and opening the door to being seen globally as the sole defender of a well-known terrorist residing in a state that was the epicentre of terrorism. China recognized that the game was up. India had also heard about China's alleged unhappiness over Pakistan's pressure on